

_Generation

Treatment by Riccardo Fusetti





_how it's going to play

“And then she opened her eyes again” - says the narrating voice.

He's referring to The Human, who is lying on the floor of an empty pitch black space.

The Human opens her eyes, tries to stand up but she can hardly walk. She starts crawling, she's learning how to move and as she tentatively and painfully makes her first steps, we notice her chest beginning to change, blurring into a shapeless blob of stars and galaxies.

This energy inside her reaches its climax and takes over more and more of her body until she is standing and about to explode:

“Bang” - goes the narrator.

...

_how it's going to play_cont.

We see an explosion of light starting from her chest, the empty white space turns white as the The Human's silhouette starts morphing into the natural elements at an incredible speed - she's now made of lava, then water, then clouds, forests, rocks, buildings, lights, cars, and then DNA strings, flowers, strawberries, insects and stars and everything in between.

Every change is listed by the narrator in a constant crescendo as The Human-canvas performs an interpretive dance embodying the events.

We are going through the beginning of life, its development and finally, its decline.

We then slow down and we're back to the black empty space. The Human is exhausted, and as she's about to open her eyes, we cut to black.

_visual style

To visually express this explosion, we are going to process every frame through a machine learning algorithm that will make each frame completely unique.

The human-AI shapeshift will have different levels of integration. The Man will start his performance without any visible modifications but as he carries on with his dance, his body will partially transform into more and more abstract shapes and colours until he is completely overtaken and barely recognizable.



**All images and videos shown in this document are low resolution tests I have generated through the AI workflow that we are going to use on the short film.*

_visual style_testing

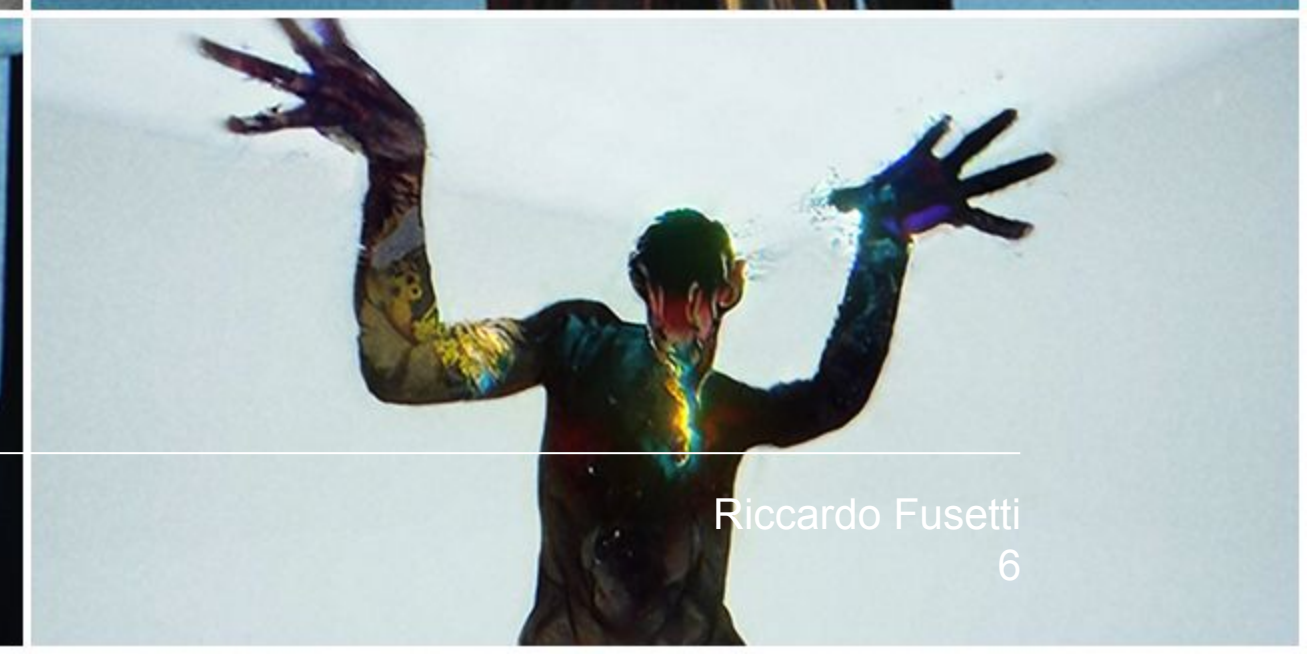
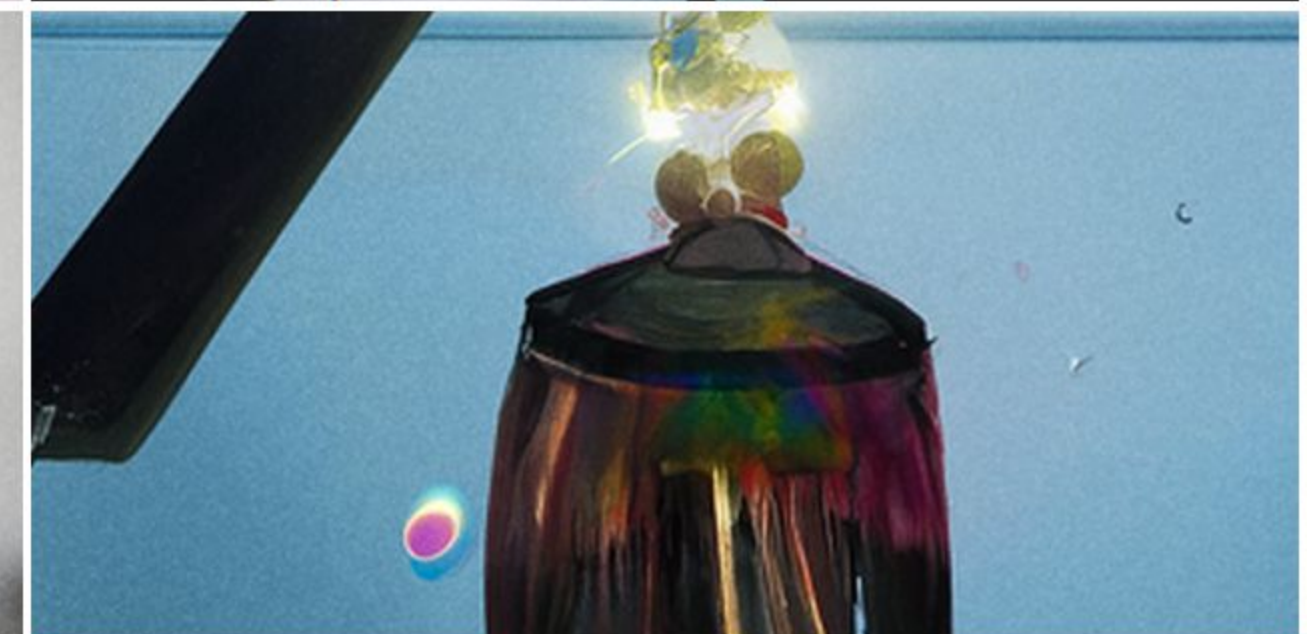
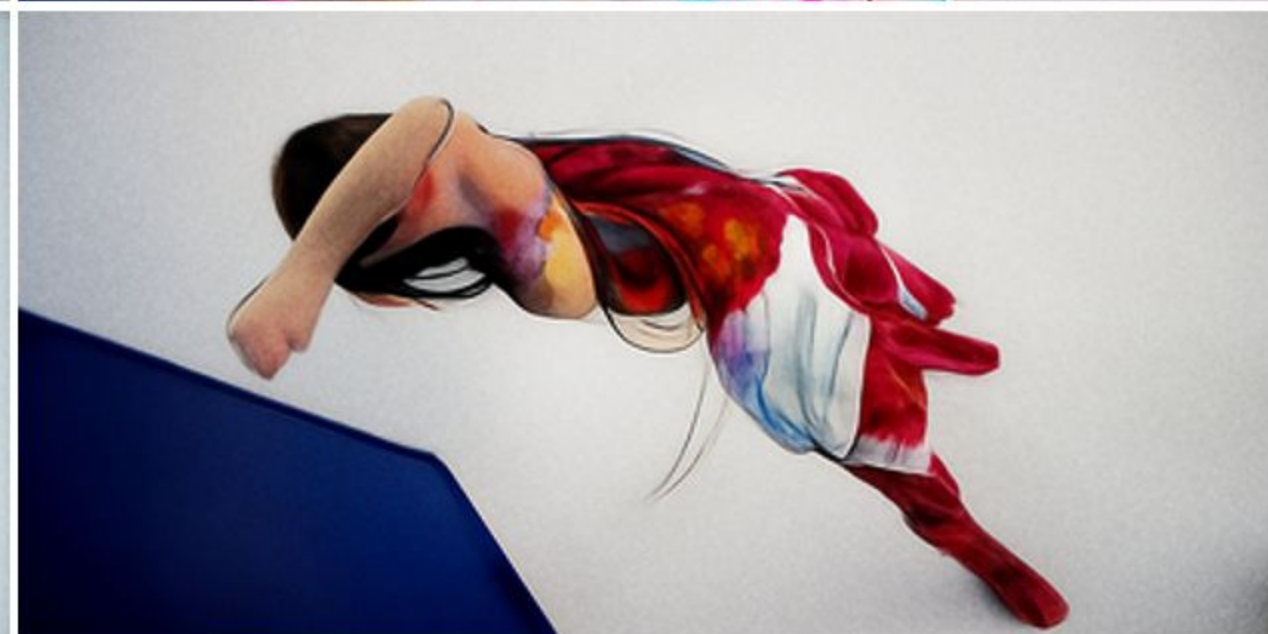
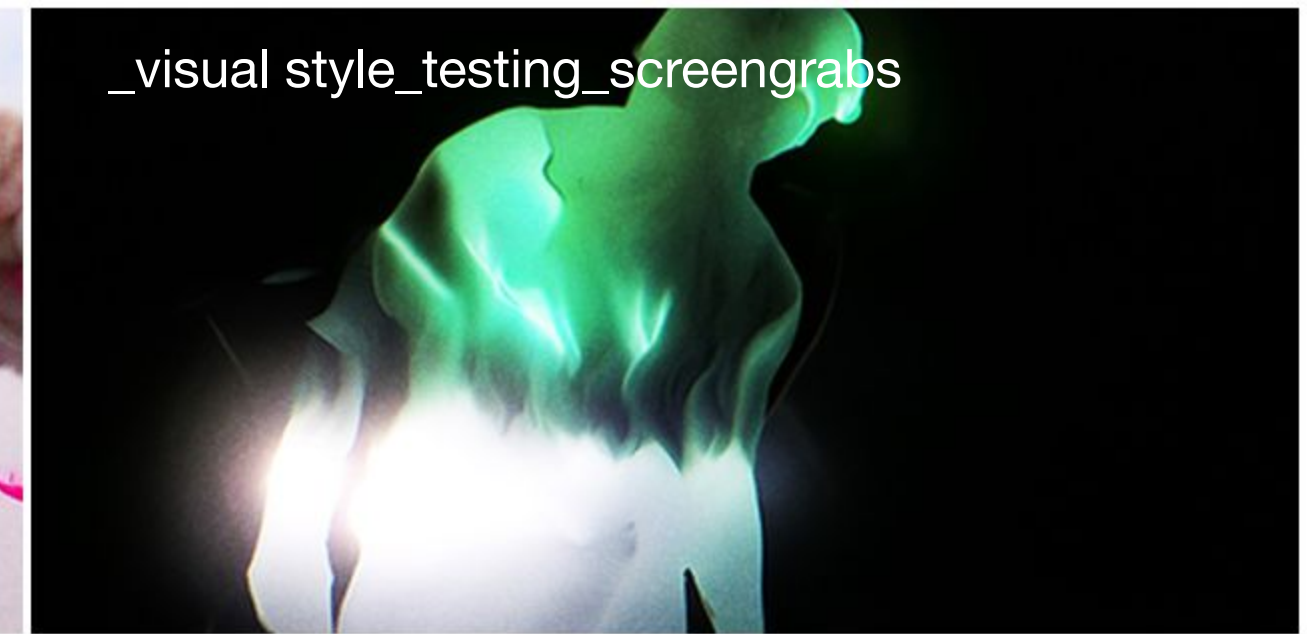


This is a montage of several tests I have run on pre-existent footage.

The tests are low resolution and most clips are coming straight out of the AI process without the masking and compositing stage, but this should give us a good representation of the visual style we will achieve on the final product.

If you pause the video at any point, you will see the level of detail and uniqueness that each frame has, while the video still maintains an homogenous flow when played at regular speed.

You can press “,” and “.” to reproduce the video frame by frame.



_visual style_testing_screengrabs

Generation | Short Film

6

Riccardo Fusetti

6

the workflow

After editing and a preliminary grade, for each shot I will isolate the subject from the background.

Some shots will be fed to the AI as they are, but for the most part I will apply some visual texture to the cutout in order to have a basis for the AI processing to work with.

For example, I can put some footage of a forest swept by the wind in the cutout of The Man and have the AI output its own interpretation of that.

After that I will composite back the results onto the original footage and then proceed with the final grade.



click to play video

_casting///performance

The dancer's performance will be one of the most crucial aspects of the film as they represent the human element and humanity in its entirety.

They will carry the weight throughout, setting the pace and truly embodying the elements shown and narrated so much that the music will be composed afterwards, based on the performance, rather than vice-versa.

The human body is treated as a canvas, both containing and expressing everything that has ever happened just with the way they carry their body.

We are looking for a dancer and choreographer, either male or female, who is able to interpret the narration in a free-flowing body performance rather than a composed dance routine.

Reference01 is a perfect example of that.

[_reference01_click to play video](#)

[_reference02_click to play video](#)



**LOST
MAN**

_casting///performance

Evie Webzell

<https://www.instagram.com/ewebzell/>



_director of photography

Natalja Safronova

<https://www.nsafronova.com/>

<https://www.instagram.com/nsafronova/?hl=en>

_narration_draft

And he saw radiations and gases and rocks
and dripping volcanoes and oceans of lava,
and dark clouds of fire, and meteors, explosions,
and water and thunder, discharges,
and raging currents, and tidal surges
and mud and moss and vines and bark
and tangle and branches and leaves and green
Then a single cell, then more cells,
then sponges, comb jellies, bacteria and fishes
and lizards and then BIG-fucking-lizards, and birds
and then EXPLOSIONS again and then ice
and then monkeys and eyes and nails and teeth and veins
and then monkeys with shoes and then words
and blood and fences and skyscrapers,
and blood and maps and paper and code,
and blood and rockets and cars and cement,
and the smell of freshly baked bread,

and then watermelon juice dripping on his skin
and the taste of seasalt off her favourite person's lips
and the lady at the store jumping the queue,
and how she gently fixes her shoes before taking them off in the house
and the storm and the sea
and the clouds are on fire again
and EXPLOSIONS again, meteors again,
water and thunder and surges again,
no more grass no more vines no more leaves no more green
no more cars no skyscrapers no monkeys
Just silence.

_sound///music

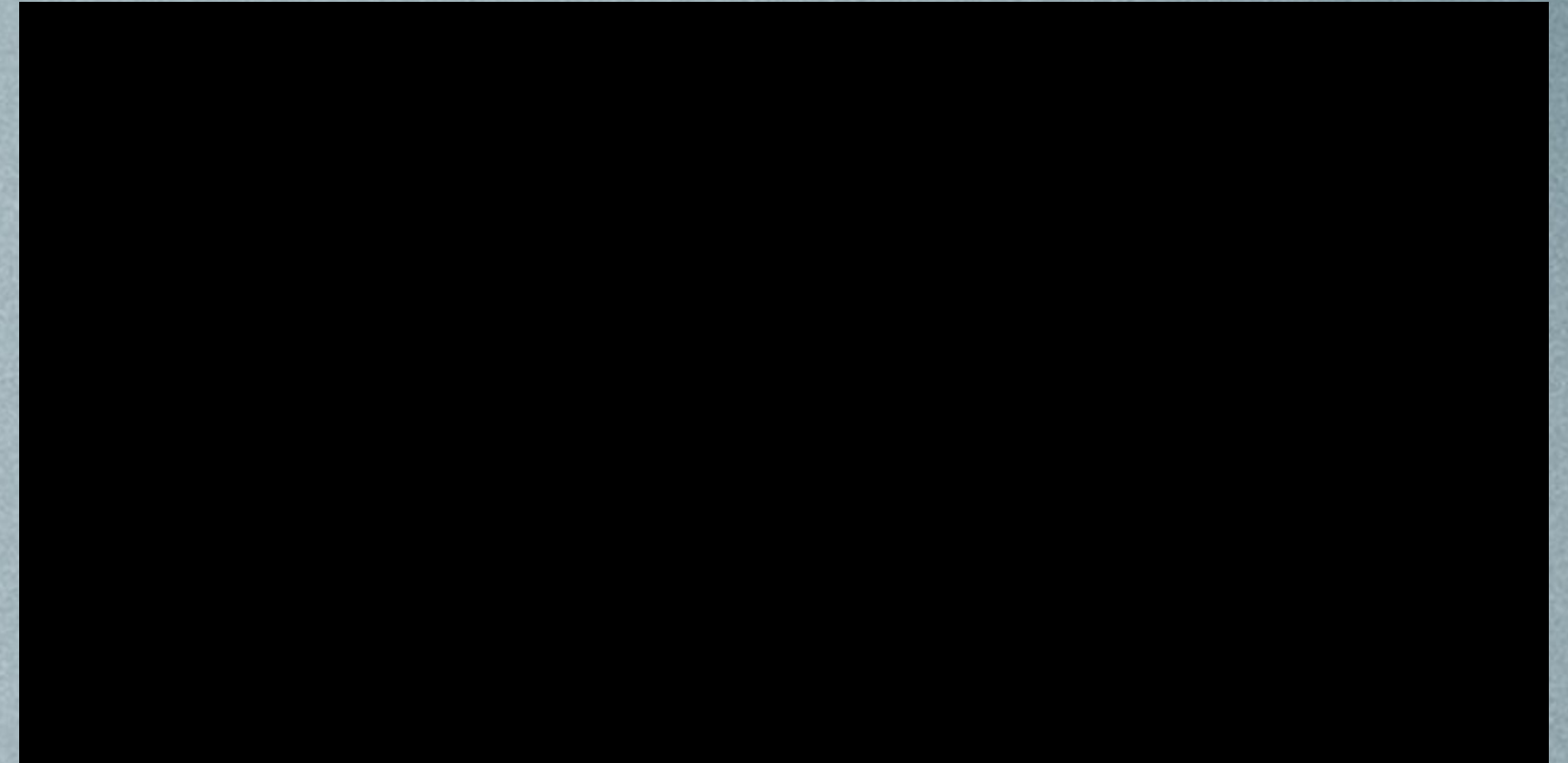
We will have an actor recite the narration, and their voice will be processed by an AI algorithm to create different iterations of the performance.

These different versions of the performance will be combined, mixed together, and cycled through to create an amalgamation of the human voice and synthesized speech.

///

I envision the music to be a constant crescendo, mixing electronic and analog instruments, driven by a strong constant beat. We are going for a drone-y exciting and trippy feel. We need to feel like we are travelling through time and space at breakneck speed, overwhelmed by everything that is happening. The music will be enhanced by the heavy impressionistic sound design.

The quiet sounds emitted by the human (the rustles of her body moving, her feet touching the ground, her breath) will be mixed with increasingly abstract sounds of nature, directly mirroring the visuals.



_click_to_play

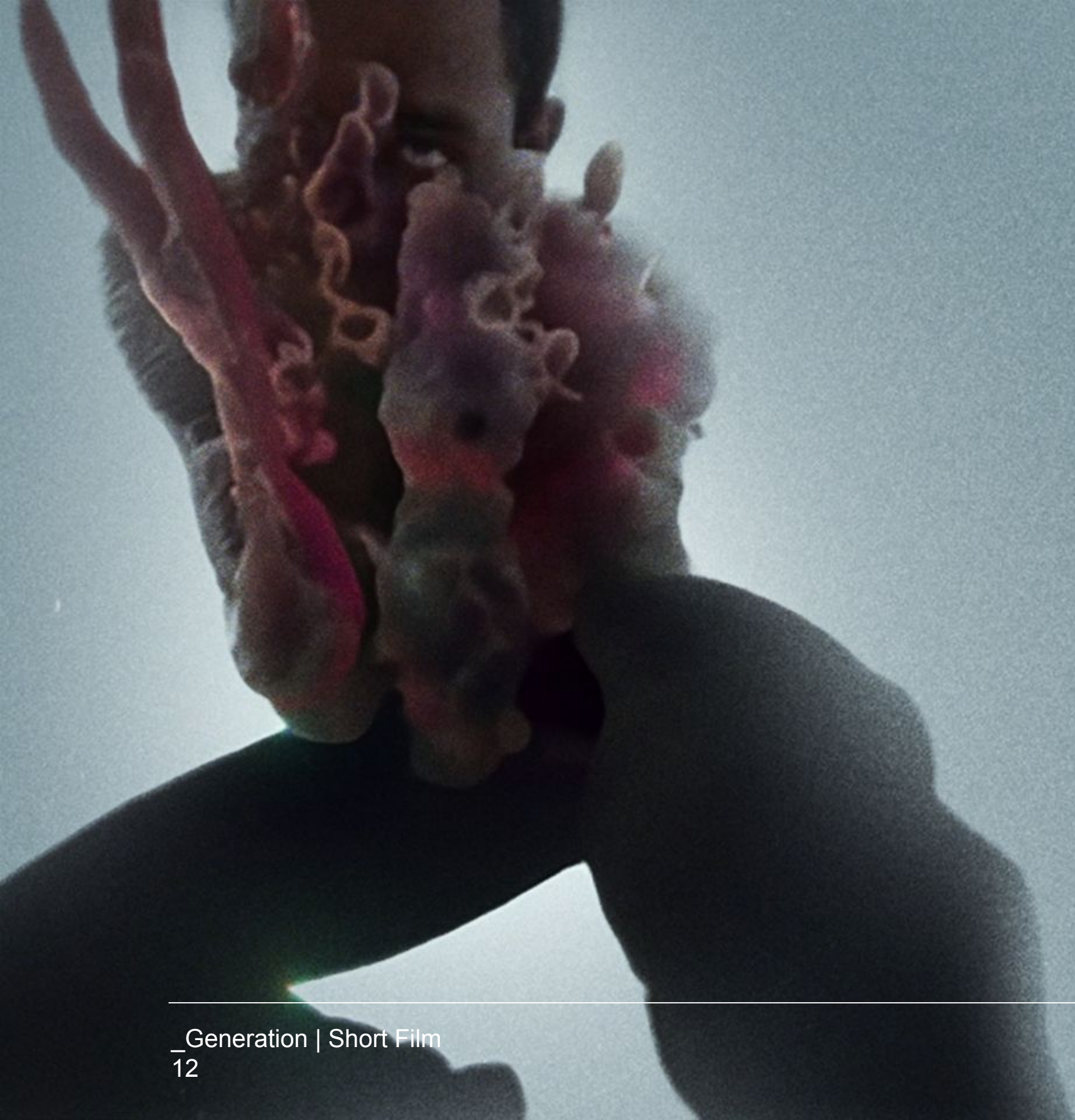
Here's a sample made with a temp recording by our VO artist on top of some reference temp track to get a general feel. There is no sound design applied.



_location

We are going to use a full blackout studio but we are also considering going the opposite direction and shoot on a infinite white cove.

This sort of blank canvas will help us put emphasis on the performance.



_conclusions

After having done extensive testing, I believe that this technology, which is still in its infancy, hasn't yet been used to such an extent and I am confident that we have all the ingredients to make a truly visually striking piece.

Another consideration is the staggering amount of human work that this specific AI workflow requires, this is in direct contrast with the common narrative that AI-generated content is completely automated and requires little more than the push of a button.

I find the general discourse around AI technology to be extremely polarized - evangelists would hail it as a complete revolution, whilst many others seem to be afraid of its potential to replace human creativity.

I personally see it as nothing more than a tool - one of many - that we can use to tell stories about the times we live in.

_thankyou.

